

Eventually, other players on the market started participating in this race. After a few slow years Samsung slowly started making its presence felt in the market. The G600 was the first serious effort by the company at a camera phone and it was quite good, with a 5 megapixel sensor that was close to, if not better, than the one on the N95. Then there was the LG Viewty, which also had a 5 megapixel camera with Schneider-Kreuznach optics and a unique 120fps slow motion video recording option (albeit at QVGA resolution). And let's not forget the Motorola ZN5, a phone with a fantastic 5 megapixel shooter and xenon flash along with Kodak branding (which didn't extend much over being just branding).

Soon we entered the golden era of 8 megapixel phones, with Sony Ericsson launching its C905, Samsung its INNOV8 (and later the Pixon) and Nokia with the N86 8MP. While there was nothing particularly special about the first two phones, Nokia went ahead and introduced a 28mm wide-angle lens (compared to the standard 35mm) and variable aperture, the latter of which is not even found on today's smartphones. A wide-angle lens meant that you could now have a greater field of view and the variable aperture would smartly adjust the aperture size depending upon the ambient light.

When it came to hitting the 12 megapixel mark, Sony Ericsson was once again first with the incredibly forgettable Satio. Samsung merely plonked a 12 megapixel sensor in the Pixon and called it a day. But Nokia went all-out in a glorious fashion with the N8 in a way that people still look back and reminisce about.. It had the biggest sensor yet on any phone and the photos it produced were phenomenal. Not that the SE or Samsung phones were bad as such but nothing compared to the quality of the N8 camera and even to this day few phones can hold a candle to it.

After that things continued to progress at a steady pace, with more evolutionary than revolutionary changes being seen. That was until Nokia



Nokia N95